

the “From” address. More often than not, with spammers using randomly generated e-mail addresses, it is likely that the “From” address will be a jumble of words.

- If the e-mail claims to be from a corporate source, check the SSL certificate of the mail to ensure that it is from the source it is supposed to be from.
- If you receive a bounced e-mail with either a virus attachment or some links to malicious sites, you know that someone’s computer has been hijacked by a worm that is sending out e-mails using your e-mail address.
- Check for disguised URLs in the body of the e-mail. If the URLs are long and have several characters in them (for example, `www.hotmail.com-SECURITYCHECKRt6uw9ru>shwideoifj>AccountMaintenance-dnif82jr-4md>gobargas.co.in`) then the links are probably fake.
- However, if the mail is in HTML, then the link can easily be cloaked. In such an instance, an easy way of checking where the URL will take you is by hovering your mouse pointer over the link and checking the link that is shown in the status bar of your browser.
- Apart from this, do the same checks that you would do to check whether the e-mail was from a phisher or a spammer.

6.4.3 Stopping Spoofs

Most spam filters and e-mail providers catch common spoofs with reasonable accuracy. One of the main steps towards this direction is the Sender Policy Framework (SPF). What SPF does is that it allows the owners of domains to identify their outgoing mail servers in DNS (see 6.3.1) and then the mail servers check the addresses in the mail headers against the DNS to determine whether the address is genuine or spoofed.